



IN PARTNERSHIP WITH

DCSTW
DC STARTUP & TECH WEEK

SPONSORSHIP & PARTNERSHIP OPPORTUNITIES

Battle of the Regions

A startup, single-elimination venture tournament spanning DC, Maryland, and Virginia — with non-dilutive prizes for amazing founders building in the DMV and 40 judges across angels, VCs, and LPs.

EVENT OVERVIEW

The DMV has world-class founders. What it has lacked is a regional stage worthy of them. Capital in the DC, Maryland, and Virginia ecosystem is concentrated, early-stage visibility is fragmented, and too many great companies go unnoticed beyond their immediate network. District Angels and DC Startup & Tech Week are changing that.

Battle of the Regions is a 36-company, single-elimination venture tournament — built to surface the DMV's most investable Seed and Series A founders, connect them directly with capital and community, and put the region on the map as a serious node in the national innovation network.

The tournament runs in two stages: regional brackets across DC, Maryland, and Virginia in Summer 2026, followed by the cross-regional "Super Six" Championship final in October 2026. Every capital prize is non-dilutive — founders keep their equity while gaining access to investors, coaching, and a room full of people who can move the needle.

Your sponsorship doesn't just put your logo on a stage. It directly funds non-dilutive capital into the hands of DMV founders who've earned it — and puts you in the room with 40 angels, VCs, and LPs and 36 of the region's most promising companies.

TOTAL NON-DILUTIVE CAPITAL

\$50,000

STARTUPS COMPETING

36 (12 per region)

REGIONS

DC · Maryland · Virginia

JUDGES

40 Angels, VCs & LPs

STAGE FOCUS

Seed & Series A

REGIONAL COMPETITIONS

Summer 2026

CHAMPIONSHIP FINAL

October 2026

EVENT PARTNERS

DC Startup Week · DC Tech Week

PRIZE MILESTONE	RECIPIENTS	PER COMPANY	TOTAL
Runner-Up Prize SUPER SIX	1 Runner-Up	\$TBD	\$TBD
Tournament Champion — "Winner of the Region"	1 Champion	\$TBD	\$TBD
Total Non-Dilutive Capital — All prizes are non-dilutive grants. Founders retain full equity.			\$50,000

* Prize structure is illustrative and will be adjusted based on how much is raised. The more sponsors we bring on, the more capital goes directly into founders' hands — every dollar raised above our baseline increases the prize pool.

TOURNAMENT FORMAT & AUDIENCE

Tournament Format

- ▶ **Stage 1 — Regional Rounds:** 12 startups per region submit 5-min pitch videos, screened by regional committees. Top 2 per region advance with a Regional Capital Prize.
- ▶ **Stage 2 — Super Six:** 6 regional winners compete in live single-elimination rounds: 5-min pitch + 2-min Q&A before a rotating investor panel.
- ▶ **First-Round Bye:** Top 2 overall scorers from Stage 1 advance directly to the Semi-Finals.
- ▶ **Judging:** Presentation & Storytelling · Business Model & Market · Investability & Scalability (1–5 scale)
- ▶ **Optional Awards:** "Regional Fan Favorite" crowd vote and/or "Most Outstanding Founder" individual award

Who's in the Room

- ▶ 36 vetted Seed & Series A founders from across the DMV
- ▶ 40 judges across angels, VCs, and LPs from across the DMV region
- ▶ District Angels investor network and Venture Fellowship cohort
- ▶ DC Startup Week and DC Tech Week audiences and communities
- ▶ University students and young professionals from DMV ecosystem programs
- ▶ Ecosystem partners: accelerators, co-working spaces, and regional orgs
- ▶ Startup press and local media

REGIONAL SUPPORTER

\$5,000

BRONZE · UNLIMITED SPOTS

BRAND & VISIBILITY — ALL EVENTS

- ✓ Logo on event registration page and all email invitations
- ✓ Logo featured on event programming slides
- ✓ Printed or digital collateral distributed at each event
- ✓ Recognition in *Battle of the Regions* post-event recap and social media

SHOWCASED AT ONE REGIONAL EVENT

- ✓ 3 reserved seats at your designated regional event

CAPITAL PARTNER

\$12,500

GOLD · 5 SPOTS AVAILABLE

BRAND & VISIBILITY — ALL EVENTS

- ✓ All Bronze brand & visibility benefits
- ✓ Named association with one Regional Capital Prize across all tournament materials
- ✓ Featured placement in post-event investor communications
- ✓ Access to full event registration list

DEAL ACCESS — ALL EVENTS

- ✓ Access to deal flow from all participating companies
- ✓ Deal allocation rights in District Angels co-investment opportunities

PER REGIONAL EVENT

- ✓ 5 reserved seats per event
- ✓ Opening or closing remarks at one regional event

CHAMPIONSHIP SPONSOR

\$25,000

PLATINUM · 2 SPOTS AVAILABLE

BRAND & VISIBILITY — ALL EVENTS

- ✓ All Gold brand & visibility benefits
- ✓ Named title sponsor of the Tournament Championship prize
- ✓ Logo in event title and across all tournament branding
- ✓ First right of refusal on future District Angels flagship events

DEAL ACCESS — IMMEDIATE

- ✓ Immediate access to deal flow from all participating companies
- ✓ Priority deal allocation rights in District Angels co-investment opportunities

BATTLE OF THE REGIONS FINAL — CHAMPIONSHIP EVENT

- ✓ 8 reserved seats at the final Championship event
- ✓ Keynote or fireside chat at the Battle of the Regions final competition

REGIONAL PARTNERSHIP OPPORTUNITIES — À LA CARTE

Available independently of tiered sponsorship. Two dedicated opportunities per region — a **Capital Prize Contributor** and a **Regional Host** — open across all three geographies.

CAPITAL PRIZE CONTRIBUTOR

Regional Capital Prize — All Regions

DC

MARYLAND

VIRGINIA

Provide named, non-dilutive capital contributions to the No. 1 and/or No. 2 Seed winners of your chosen regional bracket. Your brand is recognized throughout the tournament alongside the advancing founders from that region.

Custom Contribution

REGIONAL HOST

Venue Host — All Regions

DC

MARYLAND

VIRGINIA

Provide venue or conference space for your region's judges panel session. Hosts receive on-site branding, recognition across all event materials, and hosting credit in tournament communications. Virginia hosts: Arlington-area space preferred.

PIK / In-Kind

Fan Favorite Award Sponsor

Brand the optional crowd-voted "Regional Fan Favorite" recognition award. Includes social media callout and naming rights to the award itself.

Custom

Most Outstanding Founder Sponsor

Sponsor the individual founder recognition award — the MVP distinction — highlighting exceptional pitch performance regardless of bracket outcome.

Custom

WHY PARTNER WITH DISTRICT ANGELS

01

Provide \$50K in non-dilutive capital to Seed and Series A startups across DC, Maryland, and Virginia.

02

Connect founders with capital, mentorship, and resources from a curated regional network of angels, VCs, and LPs.

03

Increase visibility for active angels, institutional VCs, and ecosystem organizations operating across the DMV.

04

Build cross-border investor collaboration across DC, Maryland, and Virginia — reinforcing regional cohesion.

05

Create syndication, co-investment, and deal flow opportunities among diverse investor groups thesis- and stage-aligned.

06

Inspire university students and young professionals to build, join, and scale high-growth companies in the DMV ecosystem.